KWAZULU-NATAL PROVINCE
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT, TOURISM

KZN LIQUOR INDABA & BUSINESS Expo

Repositioning the Liquor Sector for Innovative Regulation, Responsibility in Practice and Inclusive Growth.

08-09 **MAY** 2026 | 08h00 | Sibaya Casino, eThekwini

Hosted by KwaZulu-Natal Economic Regulatory Authority In partnership with Department of Economic Development, Tourism and Environmental Affairs

DAY ONE: INNOVATIVE REGULATION AND RESPONSIBILITY IN PRACTICE

Focus: Building a compliant, safe, and harmonized sector through partnership, accountability, and digital innovation.

Time	Session Title and Description	Why and What It Addresses
08:00 – 09:00	**Registration and Exhibition Opens**	**Addresses:** Stakeholder integration and early value chain engagement. **Why:** Establishes an enabling environment for collaboration across regulators, traders, DFIs, FMCG partners, and technology providers.
09:00 – 09:10	**Welcome and Introductions** Programme Director sets the scene and outlines the progress of the day and how the indaba is set-up.	**Addresses:** Structuring the Indaba as a participatory, outcomes-driven platform. **Why:** Reinforces that the Indaba is designed for dialogue, accountability, and implementation.
09:10 – 09:25	**OFFICIAL WELCOME ADDRESS** **Speaker:** Mayor Ethekwini: Honourable Councillor C. Xaba *Extending a formal welcome to provincial authorities, government stakeholders, public sector representatives, and SADC delegates—with special acknowledgment of the licensees whose daily experience and expertise are central to these deliberations. This address frames the Indaba as a platform where regulator and regulated meet as partners, committed to shaping a liquor sector that works for those who operate within it and the communities they serve.*	**Addresses:** Ownership and regulator-licensee partnership. **Why:** Positions the Indaba as a shared platform for co-creating solutions.
09:25 – 09:35	**STRATEGIC CONTEXT: A new ERA of Partnership** **Speaker:** Chairperson of the Board, KZNER: Ms M.P.Myeni *Setting the vision for this Indaba by acknowledging the frustrations licensees have experienced—broken promises, regulatory inconsistencies, and engagements that felt more like lectures than dialogue. This address validates those experiences while marking a deliberate turning point. The Chairperson invites provincial authorities, government stakeholders, public sector institutions, and SADC representatives to join with licensees in building a regulatory environment shaped by transparency, mutual respect, and shared accountability. The message is clear: past failures are not hidden from but learned from, and this Indaba commits to action over talk.*	**Addresses:** Historical trust deficit and lack of implementation. **Why:** Commits to transparency, accountability, and structured follow-through.

Time	Session Title and Description	Why and What It Addresses
09:35 – 09:40	**INTRODUCTION OF THE MEC** **Speaker:** Head of Department, EDTEA: Dr N. Zulu	**Addresses:** Policy direction, transformation, and sector stability.
09:40 – 10:00	**KEYNOTE ADDRESS: A New Deal for KZN Liquor Traders** **Speaker:** MEC, Department of Economic Development, Tourism and Environmental Affairs : The Honourable Reverend Musa Zondi *Setting the provincial government's vision for a thriving, responsible, and inclusive liquor sector that balances economic recovery, public health, and regulatory integrity.*	**Addresses:** Policy direction, transformation, and sector stability
10:00 – 10:10	**Innovation Launch:** **Online Renewal System Video**	**Addresses:** Compliance inefficiencies and administrative burden. **Why:** Demonstrates digital transformation as a practical enabler of compliance.
10:10 – 11:00	**Tea Break and Exhibition Walkabout**	**Addresses:** Adoption of digital systems. **Why:** Provides hands-on support for onboarding and compliance improvement.
11:00 – 12:30	**Panel 1: Innovative Regulation And Provincial Integration** **Focus:** Aligning provincial, municipal, and regulatory bodies to support innovative liquor regulation and township economic development. **Panelists:** • EDTEA Representative • National Liquor Authority • Local Municipality Representative • SADC Representative • Liquor Industry Regulatory Expert • Provincial Regulatory Authority Representative • Trader Association Representative	**Addresses:** Regulatory fragmentation, lack of coordination, and funding constraints. **Why:** Establishes a coherent regulatory environment while simultaneously equipping traders with practical tools to access capital, addressing compliance and growth barriers in parallel.
12:30 – 13:30	**Networking Lunch**	
13:30 – 15:00	**PANEL 2: Responsible Trading, Community Governance And The Impact of Crime** **Focus:** Best practices in responsible liquor trading, community engagement, and social compact models. Examining the real-world impact of crime—including protection fees and drugs—on compliant traders. **Panelists:** • Community Policing Forum (CPF) Representative • Department of Social Development • Tavern Owner Association Leader • Alcohol Industry Responsibility Manager • **House of Traditional and Khoisan Leaders Representative** • **National Liquor Authority** • **SAPS (Crime Prevention)** • Trader Association Representative **Or A Rural/Township Operator (impacted by crime)**	**Addresses:** Crime, compliance pressures, and operational inefficiencies. **Why:** Recognises crime as a structural barrier to compliance and sustainability while providing technological solutions to improve efficiency, compliance, and resilience.
15:00 – 15:30	**Afternoon Tea Break**	
15:30 – 17:00	**Panel 3: Inclusive Growth, Market Access And Community Engagement** **Focus:** Connecting large FMCG and liquor brands to the township economy (8,862 potential outlets). Supply chain opportunities, local procurement, and empowering township entrepreneurs through community partnerships. **Panelists:** • SAB / Heineken / Distell • Coca-Cola Beverages SA • Simba / Pioneer Foods / Truda Foods • House of Traditional and Khoisan Leaders Representative	**Addresses:** Limited market access, lack of transformation, and constrained economic participation. **Why:** Expands opportunities beyond retail into manufacturing and supply chain participation, enabling inclusive growth and sustainable enterprise development.

Time	Session Title and Description	Why and What It Addresses
	• Township Retailer / Tavern Owner • Logistics / Distribution Partner • SADC Representative	
18:00 – 23:00	**GALA DINNER**	

DAY TWO: INCLUSIVE GROWTH AND ENTERPRISE DEVELOPMENT

Focus: Unlocking economic opportunities, securing funding, and formalizing the pathway to success.

Time	Session Title and Description	Why and What It Addresses
08:30 – 09:00	**Arrival Coffee**	
09:00 – 10:30	**PANEL 4: Combatting Illicit Trade And Responsibility in Practice** **Focus:** Economic and social impact of illicit trade on the liquor sector and townships. Enforcement, responsible practices, and industry collaboration. **Panelists:** • SARS (Customs And Illicit Trade Unit) • EDTEA (Inspectorate / Enforcement) • **National Liquor Authority** • Alcohol Industry Representative (SAB / Distell / Heineken) • **House of Traditional and Khoisan Leaders Representative** • Township Spaza Shop / Tavern Owner Representative	**Addresses:** Illicit trade, weak enforcement coordination, and compliance gaps. **Why:** Protects legitimate businesses by strengthening enforcement collaboration while positioning compliance as a driver of market access and growth.
10:30 – 11:00	**Networking Break**	**Addresses:** Final stakeholder engagement and opportunity consolidation.
11:00 – 11:45	**Closing Address And Way Forward** • Summary of Outcomes and Key Resolutions • Remarks from House of Traditional and Khoisan Leaders • Remarks from SADC Representative • Vote of Thanks • Announcement of 2027 Indaba Theme and Date	**Addresses:** Consolidation of resolutions and commitments. **Why:** Ensures alignment and clarity on implementation post-Indaba.
11:45 – 12:00	**Closing Ceremony** Official close by Programme Director.	
12:00	**Event Close And Departure**	
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